

Emergency Decisions Unit Pathway

Toxicology

Date DD/MM/YY

Patient details

Full
name

DoB

Unit
number

(use sticker if available)

Inclusion criteria	Patients who require a period of observation post ingestion of a substance or substances Period of observation likely to be less than 24 hours
Exclusion criteria	EWS >5 and/ or likely to be so in the next few hours. Patient needs to be at least responsive to voice. Likely to need more than 24 hours observation or treatment Patient taken paracetamol- use paracetamol pathway. May also be on this pathway if mixed overdose High likelihood of significant deterioration. Toxbase must be printed, in notes and checked for each patient for all substances taken to check for likelihood of this.

This pathway is for use in patients who have taken an overdose and require admission for a period of observation and / or treatment which is likely to be less than 24 hours.

The paracetamol pathway must be used if the patient has taken paracetamol, although this pathway can be used concurrently if further substances have been taken. Please also consider the use of the alcohol pathway as appropriate.

Mixed drug overdoses are acceptable for this pathway, providing clinicians feel patient unlikely to deteriorate significantly and fulfill other pathway criteria.

Please check Toxbase to see that patient is not at significant risk of deterioration or problems.

Patients on this pathway who have taken an intentional overdose should have capacity recorded and it noted whether or not need further mental health assessment pre- discharge.

Please also use alcohol pathway if significant co-ingestion or if patient assessed to have alcohol problems.

EDU Plan

Management checklist

All patients should have answer below circled for each statement:

Patent iv cannula if clinically indicated	Yes / NA
Drug chart written, if receiving or likely to need treatments	Yes / NA
Toxbase information printed and in the notes for substances taken	Yes
Patient at low risk of significant clinical deterioration requiring higher level of care than Edu can provide	Yes
Does the patient currently have capacity (see tool on adult mental health proforma)	Yes/ No
Further Mental Health Assessment needed pre-discharge	Yes/ No
EDU plan documented	Yes

Planned & agreed by

Print names

Signatures

Referring doctor

Emergency Physician in Charge

NB: A drug chart must be written, including patient's regular medication, before pathway can be signed off. Nerve Centre bed request only to be completed after pathway has been signed off by the EPIC.